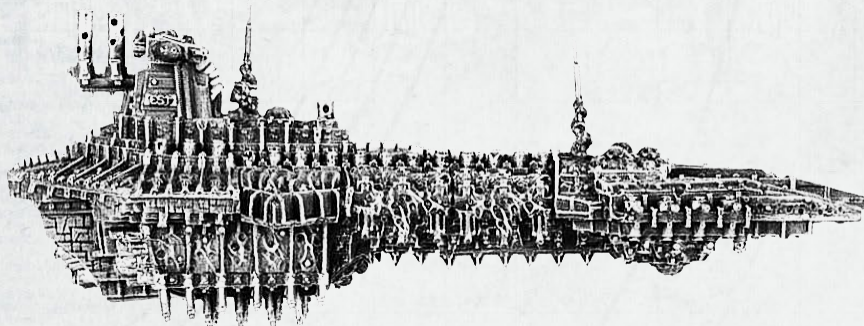




TYPE/HITS	SPEED	TURNS	SHIELDS	ARMOUR	TURRETS
Battleship/13	20 cm	45°	4	5+	4
ARMAMENT		RANGE/SPEED		FIREPOWER/STR	
Port Hives of Nurgle		30 cm		6	
Starboard Hives of Nurgle		30 cm		6	
Dorsal lance battery		45 cm		4	
Port launch bays		Swiftdeaths: 30 cm Doomfires: 20 cm Dreadclaws: 30 cm		3 squadrons	
Starboard launch bays		Swiftdeaths: 30 cm Doomfires: 20 cm Dreadclaws: 30 cm		3 squadrons	
Prow launch bays		Swiftdeaths: 30 cm Doomfires: 20 cm Dreadclaws: 30 cm		3 squadrons	
Prow lance battery		30 cm		4	

SPECIAL

- The *Terminus Est* is a unique vessel; only one may ever be in a Chaos fleet.
- It is a ponderous vessel and may not use *Come To New Heading* special orders.
- **Mark of Nurgle:** This ship bears the Mark of Nurgle as part of its point cost; it does not have to be paid for separately by the ship's commander. The extra hit is already included in its profile.
- **Flagship:** If chosen, the *Terminus Est* must be used as the fleet's flagship and have its Warmaster placed aboard it unless the Planet Killer is also present, in which case a Chaos Lord must lead it. This vessel may only bear the Mark of Nurgle. It cannot be used with any fleet that has Thousand Sons Chaos Space Marines or vessels bearing the Mark of Tzeentch unless the fleet is being led by Abaddon the Despoiler, as there is ageless enmity between the servants of the Bringer of Change and those of the Lord of Decay.
- **Miasma of Pestilence:** The *Terminus Est* is surrounded by vast swarming clouds of the same Warp-spawned flies which buzz and howl through its interior and first transformed Typhus into the Host of the Destroyer Hive. This miasma permeates outwards from the ship through blisters, boils and fractures in its surface or through corroded discharge tubes and weapon barrels. It replaces the ship's turrets and works in exactly the same way as turrets against attack craft but has no effect against torpedoes. The miasma is so thick that it obscures and distorts the shape of the *Terminus Est*, meaning that vessels within 15 cm do not benefit from a left column shift when firing at it.

FLEET LISTS

The Plaguefleet (pg. 232)

SPECIAL

- **Hives of Nurgle:** Along either side of the *Terminus Est*, row upon row of pustules, hives, and sores fester upon the ship's cankered hull. These growths cover the rusted remains of what was once the ship's main broadside batteries like coral over rock, periodically erupting violently and hurling a mixture of corroded debris, ammunition and filth out into space. The Hives of Nurgle function in exactly the same way as weapons batteries. The Nurgle player may place a single Blast marker anywhere along the *Terminus Est*'s course after each move to represent the constant seeping from these hives.

The *Terminus Est* was one of the first capital ships assigned to the Death Guard by the Emperor. It was of a unique design that pre-dated the Great Crusade and which was copied in M36 as part of the Gareox Prerogative to create the Despoiler class. As might be expected the older vessel was considerably more powerful than the later copy. Nothing definite is known of the pre-Heresy configuration of *Terminus Est*. References exist that suggest it was primarily employed as a planetary assault ship. This is not unusual as it conforms with the role assigned to the vessels of the Space Marine Legions. Many of the vessels used in the Great Crusade were, however, handicapped by system failures that the Imperium lacked the ability to repair. Often this would result in many systems being replaced with less efficient but more easily maintained alternatives. The role of *Terminus Est* during the Heresy is better known. At Istvann the *Terminus Est* engaged and destroyed *Shadow of the Emperor*, the flagship of the Raven Guard. It is argued that this engagement was the earliest recorded conflict between battleships specialised to carry attack craft. The engagement was swift and deprived the embattled loyalist forces of any air support in the massacre that followed.

When *Terminus Est* was sighted as part of the armada that followed Horus to Terra it had changed. The Mark of Nurgle was upon it and all the other vessels of the Death Guard. When Mortarion led the assault on the Lion Gate starport Typhus controlled the Plaguefleet and it is suspected actually began the orbital bombardment of the Emperor's Palace. Following Horus' death and the arrival of loyalist reinforcements the *Terminus Est*'s formidable reserves of attack craft were expended as a rearguard while the Death

Guard were evacuated back to their ships. Along with the rest of the Traitor Legions the Death Guard fled to the Eye of Terror and disappeared from Human knowledge for centuries. In the Eye it is suspected that the Traitor Legions fought amongst themselves. It is the boast of the Death Guard that their Primarch-turned-Daemon Prince Mortarion conquered a mighty empire within the Eye and transformed it to his own tastes.

Typhus and the *Terminus Est* were among the first of the Death Guard to be sighted again when they brought plague to the Agripinaa system in M35. The success of the *Terminus Est* in defeating the battlegroups sent against it had a major effect on the thinking of the Imperial Navy. In M36 an Adeptus Mechanicus expeditionary force succeeded in finding schematics of its design on the perdition world of Barabus and began building the Despoiler class. Little were they to know that the core architecture and design of the class' warp shields hid a fundamental flaw. Only when in the following centuries the vessels of this class were either lost in the Warp or turned renegade did the realization strike home. The *Terminus Est* and Typhus did not assume a central role in the Gothic War. A single sighting near Anvil 206 was the only evidence of their presence. However, considering the later incidents traced back to Anvil 206 it is clear that a particular mission was accomplished. In M41 the *Terminus Est* is one of the oldest ships known to the Imperium, the power of Nurgle holding its ancient hull together while the most virulent plagues seethe through its dank corridors. The *Terminus Est* is a part of Nurgle's realm given license to travel the stars, spreading death at the behest of its damned captain. There will be no rest for the Imperial Navy until it is finally hunted down and cleansed forever.